Microsoft outage, day two: recovery is slow

Microsoft's email and work tools were still not fully back on Friday. The company says it has found no sign of an attack, and it promises a report.

Level 2 · B1 · 277 words · 11.5 words per sentence · 14 glossed

A day after it began, the Microsoft 365 outage was still not over. On Thursday, November 12, thousands of people lost access to Outlook, Teams and Copilot. Reports about Outlook on Downdetector peaked just before 1 p.m. Eastern Time.

On Thursday, a first fix looked successful. Later, however, Microsoft said that some recovery changes had not worked as expected. Servers that had come back became unavailable again. On Friday morning, the company described only an "incremental improvement" and said that its capacity was not back to normal.

Microsoft said that recovery was complete in parts of Asia and the Pacific, and that it was extending the work to other regions. It also gave delayed email more time: it extended the email timeout to 48 hours.

The company also gave a first explanation. It said the problem was an "elevated load" caused by servers that were unexpectedly unavailable, not by more traffic. An early note said that a process for secure connections was overwhelmed. Microsoft is now applying a patch to its authentication and routing settings. These details are preliminary and may change.

Microsoft says that it has found no evidence of malicious activity. It promised a report with the root cause after the service is stable.

The effects were not the same for everyone. Teams meetings mostly kept working, but calendars and Copilot answers that depend on email did not. Connectors for AI tools from OpenAI and Anthropic were also affected.

Why does it matter? Microsoft 365 has hundreds of millions of users. A fix that works for a few hours is not the same as a full recovery, and companies that depend on one provider have to wait for it.

GLOSSARY

Downdetector	site onde usuários avisam quando um serviço está fora do ar
fix	correção, solução
incremental improvement	melhora aos poucos, em pequenos passos
capacity	capacidade, quantidade de trabalho que os servidores aguentam
timeout	tempo-limite, prazo depois do qual a tentativa é cancelada
elevated load	carga alta, excesso de trabalho nos servidores
overwhelmed	sobrecarregado
patch	correção, atualização que conserta um problema
authentication	autenticação, verificação de quem está entrando
routing	roteamento, direcionamento do tráfego
preliminary	preliminares, iniciais
malicious	mal-intencionada, feita para causar dano
root cause	causa raiz, a origem real do problema

Connectors conectores, ligações entre programas

TWO DAYS, IN EASTERN TIME

Thursday, midday	The outage begins. Reports about Outlook on Downdetector peak just before 1 p.m.
Thursday, afternoon	Microsoft says its latest fix shows signs of success.
Thursday, 10:13 p.m.	Microsoft says its attempts to fix the problem are not working as expected.
Friday, early morning	Microsoft reports “incremental improvement”, but capacity is not back to normal.
Friday, later	Recovery is complete in parts of Asia and the Pacific and is extended to other regions.

Sources: Yahoo Tech, UC Today, NBC News, ABC News (Australia). The times are the ones in the reports.

What we know, and what we do not

The story was still developing on Friday, November 13. The services were improving, but they were not fully back. This table keeps what the reports confirm apart from what is still open.

	CONFIRMED	NOT KNOWN YET
THE STATUS	Microsoft reports “incremental improvement” in several workloads, but says service health is variable and capacity has not returned to normal.	When every service and every region will be fully back.
THE FIRST FIX	On Thursday a fix looked successful. Later, Microsoft said some recovery changes did not work as expected, and servers that had returned became unavailable again.	Exactly why the first attempt failed.
THE CAUSE	Microsoft points to an “elevated load” caused by servers that were unexpectedly unavailable, not to more traffic. An early note mentions an overwhelmed process for secure connections.	The final root cause. Microsoft says a report will come after the service is stable.
A CYBERATTACK?	Microsoft says it has found no evidence of malicious activity.	Whether the final report will change this picture.
THE PATCH	Microsoft is applying a patch to upstream authentication and routing settings.	How much of the recovery depends on this patch.
EMAIL	Microsoft extended the email timeout to 48 hours, to protect delayed mail while a backlog is processed.	How many emails were delayed or lost, and how long the backlog will take.

Sources: Petri, NBC News, UC Today, ABC News (Australia), Thurrott, Yahoo. Situation on Friday, November 13, 2026. Not yet fully recovered.

WORDS IN THIS TABLE AND IN THE KEY DATES

upstream anterior no caminho, antes do ponto onde o problema aparece

backlog fila de tarefas atrasadas

AFTER READING

1. Why was Microsoft's first fix not enough?
2. What has Microsoft said about the cause so far?
3. Which questions are still open on Friday?

TALK ABOUT IT

4. Have you ever had to wait a whole day for a work tool to work again? What did you do?
5. Why can a fix that works for a few hours still fail later?
6. What should a company do when its email is down for two days?
7. Companies often wait for a final report before they explain a problem. Is that fair? Why or why not?

SOURCES

Petri, Microsoft Deploys Configuration Patch to Stabilize Global Microsoft 365 Outage

NBC News, Live updates: Microsoft scrambles to fix major outage affecting millions across the world

UC Today, Microsoft 365 Outage: Teams Held While Outlook Stayed Down

ABC News (Australia), Live: Microsoft outage hits users worldwide, affecting Teams, Outlook and Copilot

Thurrott.com, Outage Disrupts Outlook and Other Microsoft 365 Apps

Yahoo Tech, Microsoft Outlook and other services still down; company says fixes not going 'as expected'